Reading practice booklet: Grade 5 expectations

Grade 5 · Practice booklet

Name: _____

What this booklet is

This is general practice written for Reading at Grade 5 level, following the Common Core State Standards for English Language Arts standards for that grade. It is not made from your child's MAP questions, and it does not replace the classroom. Use it as a guide to what a child is expected to know and do at this level.

How to use it

- Do one section at a time, about 10 minutes, 3 days a week. Stop while it is still enjoyable.
- Read each question all the way through, twice, before answering. Underline the key words and say what is being asked.
- Take your time. A careful, correct answer is worth more than a fast one.
- Use scrap paper and show the working. Then check the answer before moving on.
- Ask your child to explain how they got an answer, even when it is right.
- If a section feels too hard, do the section before it again, or ask the teacher. That is part of learning, not a problem.

Section 1: Word meanings and how writers use words

Standards practised: RF.5.3, RF.5.4, RL.5.4, L.5.4a, L.5.4b, L.5.5a, L.5.5b, L.5.5c

A worked example

Read: "After the storm, the road was a ribbon of mud." Is this a simile or a metaphor, and what does it tell us?

1. A simile compares using "like" or "as". A metaphor says one thing IS another.
2. The sentence says the road "was" a ribbon, with no "like" or "as", so it is a metaphor.
3. A ribbon is long and thin, so the road was a long, narrow strip covered in mud.

A metaphor: it shows the road was a long, narrow strip of mud.

A Morning at the Souq

Hamdan woke before the sun, as eager as a falcon waiting for its hood to be lifted. Today he was helping his grandfather at the old souq in Deira. The narrow lanes were a maze of colour, and the air was thick with the scent of cardamom and frankincense. Grandfather, a patient man, arranged baskets of dates on the front table, each one glossy and sweet.

"Do not rush," Grandfather said. "A good trader is meticulous. He checks every basket carefully, so that no customer ever finds a bruised date."

Hamdan nodded and began to sort. The task was tedious, and soon his back ached. He felt as if the morning would never end. Then a mother and her young daughter stopped at the stall. The mother seemed hesitant, turning a jar of honey over and over, unsure whether to buy it. Grandfather smiled warmly. "Try one," he said, offering her a date. Her face lit up. "Delicious!" she said, and bought three kilos.

By noon the souq was a beehive, humming with shoppers, and the heat was scorching. Hamdan was so tired that he could barely keep his eyes open, yet he was proud. The lane that had been silent at dawn was now a river of people, and he had helped to steer a few of them toward their stall.

When the last customer left, Grandfather handed Hamdan a cold glass of laban. "You kept your cool today," he said. "That is a rare gift, and many adults never learn it." Hamdan laughed. Only that morning he had been tapping his fingers and counting the minutes. Now the sun was setting over the creek, and he did not want the day to end. It had been the opposite of boring. The lesson he carried home was a simple one: patient work, like a seed in the sand, can grow into something good.

Questions

1. The grandfather says a good trader is "meticulous". Using the clue in the next sentence, what does meticulous mean?

   A. Very careful and exact

   B. Quick and cheerful

   C. Proud and loud

   D. Strong and tall

2. The first sentence says Hamdan was "as eager as a falcon waiting for its hood to be lifted". What kind of comparison is this?

   A. A metaphor, because it says Hamdan is a falcon

   B. A simile, because it uses "as ... as" to compare

   C. A metaphor, because it mentions a hood

   D. A simile, because it names a bird

3. What does that comparison tell you about how Hamdan felt that morning?

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4. The sorting task was "tedious". Which clues help you work out the meaning?

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5. The mother was "hesitant". What does hesitant mean here?

   A. Happy and relaxed

   B. In a great hurry

   C. Unsure or unable to decide

   D. Angry with the seller

6. The prefix un- is in the word "unsure". What does un- mean, and what does unsure mean?

   A. Un- means "again"; unsure means sure once more

   B. Un- means "very"; unsure means very sure

   C. Un- means "before"; unsure means sure ahead of time

   D. Un- means "not"; unsure means not sure

7. "By noon the souq was a beehive." What does this metaphor suggest about the souq?

   A. It was very busy and crowded, full of people and noise

   B. It was quiet and empty

   C. It was full of bees and honey

   D. It was small and sweet

8. The lane is called "a river of people". What picture does this give you?

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9. Grandfather says, "You kept your cool today." What does the idiom "kept your cool" mean?

   A. Felt cold in the heat

   B. Drank something cold

   C. Stayed calm

   D. Walked away from the stall

10. The passage says the lane was "silent" at dawn and later "humming". Are these words synonyms or antonyms?

    A. Synonyms, because both describe the souq

    B. Antonyms, because silent means no sound and humming means full of sound

    C. Synonyms, because both are quiet

    D. Antonyms, because both describe the heat

11. Explain what the author means by comparing patient work to "a seed in the sand".

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12. Say the word "meticulous" aloud, tapping once for each syllable. How many syllables does it have, and how can you split it?

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13. The word "unforgettable" is long. Split it into a prefix, a root and a suffix (the t doubles before the suffix), and say what the whole word means.

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14. Find the word "carefully" in the passage. Split it into a root and its suffixes, then say how many syllables it has.

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15. Fluency task: ask your child to read the first paragraph of the passage aloud twice. What should the parent listen for?

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16. Fluency task: ask your child to read this sentence aloud: "The narrow lanes were a maze of colour, and the air was thick with the scent of cardamom and frankincense." Where should the voice pause, and what else should the parent listen for?

Section 2: Reading nonfiction

Standards practised: RI.5.1, RI.5.2, RI.5.3, RI.5.4, RI.5.5, RI.5.6, RI.5.7, RI.5.8, RI.5.9

A worked example

Read: "The well ran dry because the rain did not come. The farmers then dug a deeper well." What was the cause and what was the effect of the well running dry?

1. Ask: what happened? The well ran dry.
2. Ask: why did it happen? Because the rain did not come.
3. The reason is the cause, and what happened is the effect.

Cause: the rain did not come. Effect: the well ran dry.

Text A: The Mangroves of the Gulf Coast

Along the calm shores of the UAE grows a forest that stands in salt water. Mangrove trees live where the land meets the sea, and the most common kind here is the grey mangrove. Most plants would die in such salty water, so the mangrove has clever ways to survive. Its leaves push out extra salt, and you can sometimes see white crystals on them. Its roots also rise above the mud like small pencils. These roots take in air, because the mud around them holds very little oxygen.

Mangroves matter for two main reasons. First, they are a nursery. Young fish, shrimp and crabs hide among the tangled roots, where larger fish cannot easily reach them. Because the young are safe, more of them grow up, and fishermen later catch more fish in nearby waters. Birds such as herons and flamingos also feed in the shallow water around the trees.

Second, mangroves protect the coast. Waves lose their strength when they hit the thick roots, so the shore is washed away more gradually. A beach without mangroves can lose sand quickly in a storm, but a shore with mangroves loses much less. Mangroves also store carbon in their wood and mud, which helps to reduce the warming of the planet.

Sadly, many mangroves were cleared in the past to make room for roads and harbours. When the trees disappeared, the nurseries disappeared with them, and

fish became harder to find. Today people are working to bring the forests back. Volunteers carry young trees to the shore, plant them in the mud at low tide, and check them as they grow. Scientists count crabs and birds each year to see whether the new forests are working.

The old and new ways of thinking differ clearly. In the past, many people saw the shore as empty land to build on. Now they see it as a living wall that feeds and protects. One lesson stands out: a place that looks muddy and plain may be doing a great deal of work.

Text B: Saeed's Story

I have fished the shallow waters of this coast since I was a boy. When I was young, my father and I rowed out each dawn, and our nets came back heavy with fish. We never wondered why. The mangrove trees stood along the shore like a green wall, and I thought they had simply always been there.

Then the trees were cut down to make room for a new road. Within a few seasons, our nets came back light. Some days my brother and I caught only a handful of small fish, and we worried about feeding our families. I did not understand the link until a scientist visiting our village explained that the young fish had lost their hiding place.

Today I am glad to say that things are changing. Last spring my grandson and I helped to plant seedlings in the mud at low tide. Already I see small fish darting around the young roots again, and my catch is growing. I wish everyone who lives by the sea could see what I have seen: when we look after the shore, the shore looks after us.

Text C: Notice for Planting Day

Volunteers are welcome to help plant young mangroves at the shore reserve on Saturday 14 November. Families are welcome, and children aged 8 and over may take part with a parent.

Low tide: the water will be at its lowest at 9:30 a.m.

Arrival: please arrive at 9:00 a.m. to collect your seedlings and walk to the planting area.

Please bring: a hat, a bottle of water and old shoes that can get muddy.

Each volunteer plants up to 5 seedlings. Scientists will check the seedlings every month and count the crabs and birds each year.

Questions

1. In Text A: why do mangrove roots rise above the mud?

   A. To hold the tree up in the wind
   B. To take in air
   C. To drink fresh water
   D. To hide young fish

2. In Text A: how does the mangrove deal with the extra salt in the water?

   A. Its roots take it in and store it
   B. Its bark turns it into sand
   C. Its leaves push the extra salt out
   D. Its flowers wash it away in the rain

3. In Text A: why is a mangrove forest called a "nursery"? Use the text to explain.

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4. In Text A, what is the effect on fishermen of young fish being safe among the roots?

   A. Fishermen have to build new harbours
   B. Fishermen catch fewer fish nearby
   C. Fishermen see white crystals on the leaves
   D. Fishermen later catch more fish nearby

5. In Text A: how do mangroves protect the shore?

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6. In Text A: what happened to the fish when many mangroves were cleared? Give the cause and the effect.

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7. Text A says mangroves "store carbon". According to the text, what does this help to do?

   A. Feed the young crabs

   B. Reduce the warming of the planet

   C. Make the waves stronger

   D. Push salt out of the leaves

8. In Text A, paragraph 5 compares two ways of thinking. What are they?

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9. Name two groups of people who help bring the mangroves back, and say what each one does.

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10. The author believes mangroves are valuable. Give two reasons from the passage that support this.

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11. What does the last sentence mean: "a place that looks muddy and plain may be doing a great deal of work"?

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12. Text A and Text B are about the same topic. How do their points of view differ?

    A. Text A is told by an outside writer who gives facts; Text B is told by Saeed, who says "I" and tells what he saw

    B. Text A is told by Saeed; Text B is told by an outside writer

    C. Both are told in the first person by fishermen

    D. Both are told by scientists who count crabs

13. What do Text A and Text B both say happened to the fish after the mangroves were cleared?

    A. Fish became easier to find

    B. Fish moved to the harbours

    C. Fish became harder to find

    D. Fish grew larger

14. A family wants to join the planting day. Use Text C and Text A: what time should they arrive, and where will the seedlings be planted?

    A. 9:30 a.m. at the harbour

    B. 9:30 a.m. at the shore reserve

    C. 8:30 a.m. at the harbour

    D. 9:00 a.m. at the shore reserve

15. Saeed says small fish are darting around the young roots again. Use Text A to explain why young fish would come back when the trees grow back.

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16. Which text would you use to find out each of these? (a) How mangrove roots take in air. (b) What to bring on planting day. (c) How one fisherman felt when his nets came back light.

Section 3: Stories, poems and plays

Standards practised: RL.5.1, RL.5.2, RL.5.3, RL.5.4, RL.5.5, RL.5.6, RL.5.7, RL.5.9

A worked example

Read: "Layla felt her heart pound as she stepped onto the stage. She took a breath and began to read." Who is telling this story, and how do you know?

1. Look at the pronouns. The narrator says "Layla", "she" and "her", not "I".
2. A narrator outside the story who uses "he" or "she" is using third-person point of view.

Third person: an outsider tells the story, using "she" and Layla's name.

Text A: The Model Dhow

I was sure my model dhow would win the school boat contest. I had spent two weeks on it, gluing the hull and painting the sail bright blue. Grandfather Khalid watched me work, but he said very little, which annoyed me. I wanted him to say it was the best boat he had ever seen.

On the morning of the contest, we carried our boats to the long water trough in the courtyard. My friend Omar's boat looked plain. Its sail was a scrap of white cloth, and the hull was narrow and low. I smirked. Mine was so much prettier.

When the whistle blew, we each gave our boat a gentle push. Omar's glided across the water as smoothly as a gull. Mine wobbled, tipped to one side, and spun in a clumsy circle. The tall blue sail caught the breeze and dragged it sideways. Everyone laughed, and my cheeks burned.

I wanted to hide among the palm trees. But Grandfather came and crouched beside me. "Salem, do you know what Omar did last week?" he asked. "He tested his boat four times and changed the sail each time. He knew a boat must work well before it can look grand."

I felt a flash of anger. Then I looked at my boat, and I looked at Omar's, and I saw that Grandfather was right. Omar had not just been lucky. He had been patient.

"Can you show me how you changed the sail?" I asked Omar, even though my voice felt small.

He grinned. "Of course. Come on."

That afternoon we sat together, trimming my sail lower and adding a small weight to the hull. When I tried again, my boat floated straight. It did not win, but it finished the course, and I was surprised to find that I was not upset at all. Grandfather winked at me from the shade. He did not need to say a word.

Text B: The Solar Car

Chapter 1: The Plan

Maryam had a plan for the science fair at her school in Sharjah. Her little car would run on a solar panel and race along a ten-metre track in the courtyard. She stuck the panel on the roof and tied a tall red flag to the back. Then she decided there was no need to test it. "It will work," she told her cousin Hind. "I just know."

Chapter 2: The Test

On the day of the fair, the courtyard was bright and busy. Maryam placed her car on the line. It rolled forward, rolled a little more, and then stopped near the middle of the track. The red flag drooped. Some children whispered. Maryam's face went hot, and she picked up the car and turned away.

Hind came over. "The flag is tall, and its shadow is lying across the panel," she said gently. "Look." Maryam looked, and there it was, a dark stripe over the panel.

Chapter 3: The Second Try

Together they moved the flag to the front of the car, where it cast no shadow. Maryam set the car on the line again. This time it rolled all the way to the end of the track, and she let out a long breath. Mrs. Aisha, the judge, wrote something in her notebook. Maryam did not win first place, but she told Hind, "Next time I will test it first, and I will ask you sooner."

Picture at the end of the story: Two girls kneel beside a small car at the finish line, grinning. The red flag stands at the front of the car, and the sun is high above them.

Questions

1. How did Salem feel about his model dhow before the contest?
   A. Worried that it would sink
   B. Bored with the project
   C. Sure that it would win
   D. Embarrassed about the paint

2. Who is telling this story, and what is the point of view?
   A. Third person: a narrator outside the story uses "he" and "Salem"
   B. First person: Salem uses "I", "my" and "me"
   C. First person: Omar uses "I" and "my"
   D. Third person: Grandfather uses "he" and "him"

3. At first, why did Salem smirk when he saw Omar's boat?
   A. He thought Omar's boat looked plain and his own was much prettier
   B. He thought Omar's boat was too fast
   C. He was laughing at a joke
   D. He wanted Grandfather to see his boat

4. Why did Salem's boat tip and spin in a circle?

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5. "Omar's glided across the water as smoothly as a gull." What does this simile show?
   A. Omar's boat flew above the water
   B. Omar's boat was white like a gull
   C. Omar's boat made a loud noise
   D. Omar's boat moved smoothly and easily

6. Why did Salem's cheeks burn?

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7. What did Omar do before the contest that helped his boat glide so well?
   A. He painted his sail bright blue
   B. He added a small weight to the hull
   C. He tested his boat four times and changed the sail each time
   D. He asked Grandfather to choose the winner

8. How is Grandfather's point of view about the two boats different from Salem's at the start?

   A. Grandfather thinks a boat must work well before it looks grand; Salem cared most about looks

   B. Grandfather cares only about winning; Salem cares about working well

   C. Both care most about how the boat looks

   D. Grandfather thinks the sail should be tall; Salem thinks it should be low

9. Salem's voice "felt small" when he asked Omar for help. Why do you think so?

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10. Why did Grandfather wink and say nothing at the end?

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11. What is a theme of this story?

    A. Winning is the most important thing

    B. Boats with tall sails go fastest

    C. Grandfathers always know best

    D. Patience and careful testing matter more than looks

12. In both Text A and Text B, a character's plan goes wrong in front of others, and then another child helps. What lesson do both stories share?

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13. Compare why the plan went wrong in Text A and in Text B.

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14. Text B is told in three chapters. Which chapter holds the problem, and how does the next chapter depend on it?

    A. Chapter 1 holds the problem; Chapter 3 repeats it

    B. Chapter 2 holds the problem (the car stops); Chapter 3 solves it by moving the flag

    C. Chapter 3 holds the problem; Chapter 2 solves it

    D. Chapter 2 holds the problem; Chapter 3 shows the car never finishes

15. How does Chapter 1 of Text B help you understand what goes wrong in Chapter 2?

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16. The picture at the end of Text B shows two girls grinning beside the car, with the flag at the front. What does the picture add to the ending?

Answer guide for parents

Section 1: Word meanings and how writers use words

1. A. Very careful and exact. The next sentence says he checks every basket carefully, so meticulous means very careful and exact. If your child chose B, they guessed from the cheerful mood, not from the clue.
2. B. A simile, because it uses "as ... as" to compare. The words "as eager as" show a simile. If your child chose A, they thought any comparison is a metaphor, but a metaphor says one thing is another with no as or like.
3. A good answer says Hamdan was excited and keen to start, like a falcon ready to go. Ask: which word in the sentence tells you how he felt? (eager).
4. A good answer says his back ached and the morning seemed never to end, so tedious means boring and tiring. Ask: how would you feel doing a job like that?
5. C. Unsure or unable to decide. The same sentence says she was unsure whether to buy it. If your child chose A, they pictured a happy shopper, but she kept turning the jar over and could not decide.
6. D. Un- means "not"; unsure means not sure. Un- means not, so unsure means not sure. If your child chose B, they thought un- makes a word stronger, but un- turns a word into its opposite.
7. A. It was very busy and crowded, full of people and noise. A beehive is busy and humming, and the text says the souq was humming with shoppers. If your child chose C, they took beehive word for word, but the author is comparing.
8. A good answer says people moving along in a steady flow, like water in a river. Ask: what do a river and a crowd have in common?
9. C. Stayed calm. To keep your cool means to stay calm. If your child chose A, they read it word for word as cold, but the sentence is about how he behaved.
10. B. Antonyms, because silent means no sound and humming means full of sound. Silent means no sound and humming means full of sound, so they are opposites. If your child chose C, they thought both words were quiet, but humming is a steady noise.
11. A good answer says patient work may look small and take time, like a seed, but it can grow into something good. Ask: what small job could grow into something big?
12. 4 syllables: me-tic-u-lous. Tap four times as you say it slowly. Ask: can you tap it again without looking at the page?
13. A good answer splits it as un-, forget and -able, and says it means not able to be forgotten. Ask: what does the prefix un- do to a word?
14. A good answer says the root is care with the suffixes -ful and -ly, and counts 3 syllables: care-ful-ly. Ask: what does each ending add to the meaning?
15. A good answer listens for most words read correctly, a steady pace, pauses at commas and full stops, and some expression. Ask: which reading sounded smoother, the first or the second?
16. A good answer pauses at the comma after "colour" and at the full stop, and reads cardamom and frankincense smoothly. Ask: which long word was hardest, and can you read it once more?

Section 2: Reading nonfiction

1. B. To take in air. The text says the mud holds very little oxygen, so the roots take in air. If your child chose A, they gave a reason that sounds sensible for roots, but the text does not say it.
2. C. Its leaves push the extra salt out. The text says its leaves push out extra salt, and you can see white crystals on them. If your child chose A, they mixed up the roots, which take in air, with the leaves.
3. A good answer says young fish, shrimp and crabs hide safely among the roots while they grow up, like babies in a nursery. Ask: who can reach them among the tangled roots?
4. D. Fishermen later catch more fish nearby. The text says more young fish grow up, so fishermen later catch more nearby. If your child chose B, they reversed the effect, because safe young fish mean more fish, not fewer.
5. A good answer says waves lose their strength when they hit the thick roots, so less of the shore is washed away. Ask: what happens to a beach without mangroves in a storm?
6. A good answer gives the cause, the trees and their nurseries disappeared, and the effect, fish became harder to find. Ask: which word, because or so, links the two?
7. B. Reduce the warming of the planet. The text says storing carbon helps reduce the warming of the planet. If your child chose D, they mixed it up with the leaves pushing out salt, which is a different job.
8. A good answer says in the past people saw the shore as empty land to build on, and now they see it as a living wall that feeds and protects. Ask: which words begin each way of thinking?
9. A good answer names volunteers, who plant and check young trees, and scientists, who count crabs and birds each year. Ask: how does counting animals show if the forest is working?
10. A good answer gives any two reasons: a nursery for young sea animals, protection from waves, storing carbon, or feeding birds. Ask: which reason matters most to you, and why?
11. A good answer says something plain can still be very useful, and mangroves shelter animals and protect the shore. Ask: what other plain thing do you know that does a lot of work?
12. A. Text A is told by an outside writer who gives facts; Text B is told by Saeed, who says "I" and tells what he saw. Text A is written by an outside writer who gives facts, and Text B says I and tells what Saeed saw. If your child chose C, they thought both writers were fishermen, but Text A never says I.
13. C. Fish became harder to find. Text A says fish became harder to find, and in Text B Saeed's nets came back light. If your child chose A, they picked the opposite of what both texts say.
14. D. 9:00 a.m. at the shore reserve. Text C says to arrive at 9:00 a.m., and the planting is at the shore reserve. If your child chose B, they used 9:30, which is the low tide time, not the arrival time.
15. A good answer says young fish hide among the tangled roots where larger fish cannot easily reach them, so new trees give a safe nursery again. Ask: which sentence in Text A says this?
16. Text A. (a) Roots taking in air is explained there. (b) Text C. (c) Text B. A good answer says why, for example that Text B tells one man's feelings. Ask: which text gives a list of what to bring?

Section 3: Stories, poems and plays

1. C. Sure that it would win. The story begins "I was sure my model dhow would win." If your child chose A, they picked a worry that only comes later, when the boat tips.
2. B. First person: Salem uses "I", "my" and "me". Salem uses I, my and me, so he is telling it. If your child chose A, they saw the names Salem and Grandfather and thought a narrator outside the story was speaking.
3. A. He thought Omar's boat looked plain and his own was much prettier. Salem says Omar's boat looked plain and "Mine was so much prettier." If your child chose B, they picked a detail from later, when Omar's boat glided.
4. A good answer says the tall blue sail caught the breeze and dragged the boat sideways. Ask: which part of the boat did Salem care most about?
5. D. Omar's boat moved smoothly and easily. The comparison with a gull shows how smoothly and easily the boat glided. If your child chose A, they thought the boat really flew, but a simile only compares.
6. A good answer says he was embarrassed because everyone laughed at his boat. Ask: how do you feel in your face when you are embarrassed?
7. C. He tested his boat four times and changed the sail each time. Grandfather says Omar tested his boat four times and changed the sail each time. If your child chose B, they picked what Salem did after the contest, not what Omar did before.
8. A. Grandfather thinks a boat must work well before it looks grand; Salem cared most about looks. Grandfather says a boat must work well before it can look grand, while Salem cared most about looks. If your child chose B, they swapped the two points of view.
9. A good answer says he felt shy or embarrassed after smirking at Omar's plain boat and then needing his help. Ask: how would you feel asking for help from someone you laughed at?
10. A good answer says Grandfather was pleased and proud that Salem learned the lesson without being told again. Ask: why can a wink say more than words?
11. D. Patience and careful testing matter more than looks. Omar's plain, well tested boat glided well, and Salem's improved once he asked for help. If your child chose A, they picked what Salem believed at the start, which the story shows is wrong.
12. A good answer says learning from a mistake and accepting help makes your work better, or that testing and patience matter. Ask: how did each character change after being helped?
13. A good answer says Salem cared most about looks, so his tall sail made the boat tip, and Maryam skipped testing, so the flag's shadow covered the panel. Ask: what could each child have done first?
14. B. Chapter 2 holds the problem (the car stops); Chapter 3 solves it by moving the flag. In Chapter 2 the car stops, and in Chapter 3 the girls move the flag and it finishes. If your child chose D, they stopped reading before the end of Chapter 3.
15. A good answer says Chapter 1 shows the tall flag and that Maryam did not test, which sets up the shadow on the panel. Ask: which detail in Chapter 1 turns out to matter later?
16. A good answer says the picture shows the problem is solved, with the flag at the front, and that the girls are happy together. Ask: what can a picture show that the words did not say?